HW 2 - Zorka Albert

1. The Niche of Neffke, Otto & Weyh (2017)

The research question is, whether inter-industry labor flows can be a measure of skill relatedness, and are they structured enough for it. We can conclude that human capital is not industry specific from the fact that workers switch industries, but while making this conclusion we might overlook which industries are the ones changing workers. The paper argues that earlier measures looked at relatedness indirectly, not directly, from where workers move to where even though it can reveal skill overlap directly. The paper shows that labor flows are within a few industry pairs that form a stable skill-relatedness network that can predict regional diversification better than earlier measures.

2. Citing articles

1. R. Maria del Rio-Chanona, Penny Mealy, Mariano Beguerisse-Díaz, François Lafond, J. Doyne Farmer; Occupational mobility and automation: a data-driven network model. J. R. Soc. Interface. 1 January 2021; 18 (174): 20200898. https://doi.org/10.1098/rsif.2020.0898
    - It applied labor-flow mobility networks to occupations showing how automation displaced workers as the escape routes depend on network positions.

2. Neave O'Clery, Stephen Kinsella, Modular structure in labour networks reveals skill basins, Research Policy, Volume 51, Issue 5, 2022, 104486, ISSN 0048-7333, https://doi.org/10.1016/j.respol.2022.104486. (https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S0048733322000142)
    - Used UK data and applied community detection to the labor-flow network in order to find skill clusters that predict city-industry growth better than nearest-neighbor relatedness.

3. My niche

While Anelli et. al (2021) showed that robot exposure raises radical right voting, Neffke et. al showed that labor flows are limited to skill-related paths. We do not know if the political effect depends on how many skill-related but non-automated industries are available for replaced workers in the region. If it is the case, the political radicalization comes from limited "escape-routes" and not from automation.

Research question: Can the radical right voting share due to robot exposure be weakened by introducing regional skill-related jobs outside of the exposed industries?

4. Data and users

The published skill-relatedness matrices by Neffke et. al, IFR robot data, and Bundeswahlleiter regional data. Users: governments and employment agencies.

AI prompt: https://share.gemini.google/4bX1nZvaAZAQ